

1. Master roadmap — Part III as a connected constitutional system

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARCHITECTURE): Part III is a constitutional operating system, not a bare catalogue: Articles 12-13 identify bound power and invalid law, Articles 14-30 secure six present rights, Article 32 supplies the remedy, and Articles 31A-35 plus 358-359 control exceptional protection or enforcement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (FINAL VERDICT): Fundamental Rights are neither absolute liberties nor revocable State gifts: they are transformative, judicially enforceable guarantees whose legitimacy lies in exact text, proportionate limitation, positive protection and a non-derogable rule-of-law core.

GATEWAY	SIX CURRENT RIGHTS
Article 12 identifies State -> Article 13 invalidates inconsistent law to the extent of conflict.	Equality 14-18 -> Freedom 19-22 -> Exploitation 23-24 -> Religion 25-28 -> Cultural/Educational 29-30 -> Remedies 32.
CONTROLS	EXAM ALGORITHM
31A-31C saving clauses -> 33-35 special competence -> 358-359 Emergency effects.	Right -> beneficiary/respondent -> exact ground -> doctrine/test -> remedy -> saving/Emergency caveat -> qualified verdict.

Property moved to Article 300A; Articles 20 and 21 form the non-derogable Article 359 core.

2. Beneficiary, horizontality and proportionality matrix

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (BENEFICIARIES / HORIZONTALITY): Fundamental-right analysis must separate beneficiary from respondent: some guarantees belong only to citizens, many protect every person, and Articles 15(2), 17, 23 and 24 directly reach specified private conduct while positive duties may require State protection.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (QUALIFIED RIGHTS / PROPORTIONALITY): Indian Fundamental Rights are qualified but not defeasible at executive will: every restriction must rest on valid law, fit the exact constitutional ground, pursue a legitimate aim and remain rational, necessary, balanced and procedurally safeguarded.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (PROPERTY / EMERGENCY CORE): The Forty-fourth Amendment moved property from Part III to the constitutional guarantee in Article 300A and made Articles 20 and 21 non-derogable from an Article 359 enforcement order.

Axis	Core map	Close-option control
Citizen-only	15, 16, 19 and 29 use citizen language.	Article 30 says all minorities; quote text accurately.
All persons / person-protective	14, 20-25; Article 22 subject to its internal exceptions.	Companies/juristic persons invoke only where the right fits.
Direct horizontal reach	15(2), 17, 23 and 24.	Private body need not become Article 12 State.
Remedial/public-duty reach	Private detention -> habeas corpus; public duty -> Article 226.	Article 12 and Article 226 are different inquiries.
Modern restriction test	Law -> exact aim/ground -> rational connection -> necessity -> balance -> safeguards.	Proportionality cannot replace the Article's text.
Property/Emergency	Article 300A constitutional right; Articles 20/21 protected from Article 359.	Not a Fundamental Right; not merely an ordinary legal right.

3. Article 12 — State and public-duty routes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 12): Article 12 looks beyond legal form to governmental domination: an entity may be State when its financial, functional and administrative relationship reveals pervasive governmental control, while Article 226 may separately reach a non-State body performing a public duty.

EXPRESS BODIES	CASE ARC
Union Government + Parliament; State Government + Legislature; local authorities; other authorities in India or under Government of India control.	Rajasthan Electricity Board rejects sovereign-function narrowness -> R.D. Shetty / Ajay Hasia develop instrumentality -> Pradeep Kumar Biswas demands pervasive financial, functional and administrative domination.
INDICATORS	ARTICLE 226 DISTINCTION
Government ownership/finance; deep control; public importance; State monopoly; transferred department; cumulative relationship.	A body may fail Article 12 yet remain amenable to writ for a public duty. Corporate/society form is never conclusive.

Trap: government funding alone is not automatically decisive; form neither includes nor excludes.

4. Article 13 — law, voidness doctrines and amendment boundary

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 13): Article 13 converts rights into judicially enforceable limits by defining law broadly and using severability, eclipse and non-waiver, while constitutional amendments are reviewed through Article 368 and the basic-structure boundary.

Node	Rule	Authority / caveat
Law	Ordinance, order, bye-law, rule, regulation, notification, custom or usage with force of law.	Article 13(3)(a).
Pre-Constitution law	Void to extent of inconsistency; classical eclipse may leave it dormant.	Bhikaji Narain Dhakras.
Post-Constitution law	State shall not abridge FR; contravening part void to extent.	Article 13(2); ordinarily void from inception to extent.
Severability	Remove separable invalid part if remainder works and matches legislative intent.	Never judicially rewrite an inseparable scheme.
No waiver	Consent/estoppel cannot validate unconstitutional State action.	Basheshar Nath; Olga Tellis.
Prospective overruling	Court may protect settled past transactions when announcing a new rule.	Golaknath used it; not automatic.
Amendment arc	Shankari Prasad/Sajjan Singh -> Golaknath -> 24th Amendment -> Kesavananda -> Minerva Mills.	Amendment review now follows basic structure, not ordinary Article 13 review.

5. Equality code I — Article 14, Article 15 and Article 16

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 14): Article 14 combines equality before law with equal protection: it permits reasonable classification only through intelligible differentia and rational nexus, and independently invalidates arbitrary State action.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLES 15-16): Articles 15 and 16 move equality from non-discrimination to substantive opportunity by prohibiting exact grounds yet authorising carefully targeted special provisions and reservation through distinct enabling clauses.

Provision	Core test / grounds	Enabling or limiting detail
Article 14	Equality before law + equal protection; differentia + nexus; anti-arbitrariness.	Permits reasonable classification, not class legislation.
Article 15(1)	Religion, race, caste, sex, place of birth.	Discrimination only on these grounds; citizen-specific.
Article 15(2)	Access to shops, public restaurants, hotels, places of entertainment and public-use wells/tanks/roads etc.	Specified private horizontal reach.
Article 15(3)-(6)	Women/children; SEBC/SC/ST; admissions incl. private unaided except minority; EWS.	Clauses are distinct—do not merge beneficiaries or fields.
Article 16(1)-(2)	Equal public-employment opportunity; religion, race, caste, sex, descent, place of birth, residence.	Residence ground differs from Article 15; Article 16(3) requires parliamentary law.
Article 16(4)-(6)	Backward class inadequate representation; SC/ST promotion; backlog; EWS.	Enabling, not an individual command to reserve every post.

6. Equality code II — reservation controls, Article 17 and Article 18

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (RESERVATION CONTROL): Reservation is a technique of substantive equality, but its design remains evidence-based, reviewable and attentive to creamy-layer exclusion, representation, promotion conditions, backlog treatment, EWS text and administrative efficiency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLES 17-18): Articles 17 and 18 attack inherited civic hierarchy horizontally and symbolically: untouchability is abolished and punishable, while titles are prohibited without invalidating military, academic or properly used national distinctions.

INDRA SAWHNEY	PROMOTION / BACKLOG
OBC reservation upheld; creamy layer; ordinary 50% ceiling with narrow extraordinary space; Article 16(4) did not then authorise promotion.	77th -> 16(4A); 81st -> 16(4B); 82nd -> Article 335 proviso; 85th -> consequential seniority. Nagaraj/Jarnail Singh retain data/efficiency controls.
EWS / SUB-CLASSIFICATION	ARTICLES 17-18
Janhit Abhiyan upholds 103rd Amendment by majority. Davinder Singh permits evidence-based SC sub-classification but neither mandates it nor changes Article 341 list.	Article 17 is absolute and horizontal, supported by Protection of Civil Rights Act 1955 and SC/ST Act 1989. Article 18 bars titles; national awards remain valid if not used as prefixes/suffixes.

Efficiency under Article 335 is a constitutional consideration, not a caste-neutral slogan preserving inherited exclusion.

7. Article 19 — six freedoms and exact restriction grounds

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 19): Article 19 protects six citizen freedoms through clause-specific discipline: the State must identify the exact restriction clause and closed ground, after which reasonableness and proportionality test the means.

Freedom	Clause	Exact restriction control
Speech/expression	19(1)(a) / 19(2)	Sovereignty/integrity; security of State; friendly foreign relations; public order; decency/morality; contempt; defamation; incitement.
Peaceful unarmed assembly	19(1)(b) / 19(3)	Sovereignty/integrity; public order.
Associations/unions/co-operative societies	19(1)(c) / 19(4)	Sovereignty/integrity; public order; morality.
Movement within India	19(1)(d) / 19(5)	General public; protection of Scheduled Tribe interests.
Residence/settlement	19(1)(e) / 19(5)	General public; protection of Scheduled Tribe interests.
Profession/occupation/trade/business	19(1)(g) / 19(6)	General public; professional/technical qualifications; State monopoly.

Foreign travel is Article 21, not Article 19(1)(d); no Fundamental Right to strike; press freedom derives from Article 19(1)(a).

8. Speech, digital freedom, political information and Section 152

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CURRENT CASES): Current Part III analysis must be date-bounded: Electoral Bonds protects political-funding information, Davinder Singh permits evidence-based Scheduled Caste sub-classification, Property Owners preserves original Article 31C, DPDP commencement is phased, and BNS section 152 remains under a notified constitutional challenge without a located final merits decision.

1950 -> FIRST AMENDMENT	INCITEMENT / DIGITAL
Romesh Thappar / Brij Bhushan invalidated early controls. First Amendment added reasonable, public order, friendly relations and incitement; 16th Amendment later added sovereignty/integrity.	Kedar Nath read old 124A to incitement/public disorder. Shreya Singhal struck 66A, protected discussion/advocacy short of incitement, upheld 69A safeguards and read down 79.
INTERNET / DEFAMATION	ELECTORAL BONDS / BNS 152
Anuradha Bhasin: publish orders, proportionality, review, no indefinite suspension; protects freedoms through internet, not a standalone universal internet right. BNS 356 now carries criminal defamation.	2024 judgment protects voter information. BNS 152 uses different secession/rebellion/subversion/separatism language. Supreme Court issued vires notice 28 Aug 2025; no final merits decision located through 21 Aug 2026.

9. Articles 20 and 21 — criminal shields and the dignity charter

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 20): Article 20 creates three person-protective criminal shields against retrospective penal liability, repeated prosecution-and-punishment for the same offence, and compelled testimonial self-incrimination.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 21): Article 21 became a dignity charter when Maneka Gandhi required fair, just and reasonable procedure and linked liberty with Articles 14 and 19, enabling named protections without turning every policy aspiration into an unlimited entitlement.

Node	Exam rule	Named evidence / limit
20(1)	No retrospective offence or greater penalty; beneficial criminal change may help accused.	Not every retrospective civil/tax/procedural law is barred.
20(2)	No prosecution and punishment for same offence more than once.	Departmental proceedings are not automatically prior prosecution.
20(3)	Accused + compulsion + testimonial self-incrimination.	Kathi Kalu Oghad distinguishes physical evidence; Selvi protects testimonial autonomy.
21 arc	Gopalan silo -> R.C. Cooper effect -> Maneka fair, just, reasonable procedure with 14/19/21 interlock.	Text remains procedure established by law; fairness supplies due-process standard.
Dignity rights	Speedy trial, legal aid, livelihood, prisoner dignity, arrest safeguards, shelter, health, environment, travel, choice, autonomy, dignified dying.	Named rights usually secure fair process/minimum protection, not unlimited judicial welfare.

10. Privacy, DPDP phased commencement and Article 21A

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 21A): Article 21A constitutionalises free and compulsory education for children aged six to fourteen, implemented by the RTE Act while preserving the distinct Article 30 position of minority institutions.

PUTTASWAMY TEST	DNA / PATERNITY
Privacy covers bodily integrity, decisional autonomy and information. Limitation requires law -> legitimate aim -> proportionality -> safeguards.	BSA Section 116 presumption; strong prima facie/eminent need; child's welfare and dignity; less intrusive evidence; no routine fishing test.
DPDP STATUS 21 AUG 2026	ARTICLE 21A / RTE
G.S.R. 843(E): first Act tranche operative; Section 6(9)/27(1)(d) from 13 Nov 2026; most remaining provisions from 13 May 2027. G.S.R. 846(E): Rules 1,2,17-21 operative; later tranches pending.	Six-to-fourteen free and compulsory education; 86th Amendment also reshaped Article 45 and added 51A(k). RTE 25% obligation excludes minority institutions after Pramati.

DPDP notification is not full implementation and does not displace constitutional Puttaswamy review.

11. Article 22 — ordinary arrest versus preventive detention

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 22): Article 22 separates ordinary arrest from preventive detention: the first carries grounds, counsel and twenty-four-hour production safeguards, while the second follows a distinct regime whose current no-Advisory-Board ceiling remains three months.

Branch	Safeguards / rule	Current-law caution
Ordinary arrest	Grounds as soon as may be; lawyer of choice; nearest magistrate within 24 hours excluding journey; no further custody without authority.	BNSS 47 informs grounds/bail; 48 relative/friend; 58 twenty-four-hour ceiling.
Article 22(3) exceptions	Clauses (1)-(2) exclude enemy alien and preventive detainee.	Preventive detainees still receive clauses (4)-(7).
Preventive detention	Anticipatory not punitive; current text allows up to three months without Advisory Board; grounds + earliest representation; public-interest withholding.	Do not import ordinary-arrest counsel/24-hour rules wholesale.
44th Amendment trap	Proposed two-month substitution and Board restructuring.	Not commenced; operative constitutional period remains three months.

12. Articles 23-24 — exploitation and labour dignity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLES 23-24): Articles 23-24 constitutionalise labour dignity against State and private exploitation: trafficking, begar (forced unpaid labour), economically compelled forced labour and prohibited child labour attract both rights remedies and statutory enforcement.

ARTICLE 23 PROHIBITIONS	ECONOMIC COMPULSION
Trafficking; begar (forced unpaid labour); similar forced labour. Applies against State and private persons and protects citizens/non-citizens.	PUDR/Asiad Workers: below-minimum payment in economic compulsion can be forced labour. Bandhua Mukti Morcha links abolition, dignity and enforcement.
COMPULSORY SERVICE	ARTICLE 24 + STATUTES
Article 23(2) permits public-purpose compulsory service but bars discrimination in imposing it only on religion, race, caste or class.	No child below 14 in factory, mine or other hazardous employment. Child and Adolescent Labour Act 1986 (amended 2016), Bonded Labour Abolition Act 1976, trafficking law, Article 21A/RTE.

13. Articles 25-28 — conscience, denomination, ERP and institutional categories

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLES 25-28): Indian religious freedom protects conscience and denominational autonomy while permitting public-order, health, morality, secular-regulation and social-reform controls; the governing model is principled distance, not either theocracy or an absolute wall.

Node	Protected field	Limit / trap
Article 25	All persons: conscience; profess, practise, propagate.	Public order, morality, health, other FRs, secular regulation/reform; propagation excludes force/fraud/allurement.
Article 26	Denomination: institutions; religious affairs; property ownership; administration by law.	Religious affairs stronger than regulable secular property administration.
ERP	Shirur Mutt religious/secular distinction; essentiality inquiry where invoked.	Critique: judges as theologians; use text, competing rights, harm and proportionality.
Article 27	No compelled tax specifically appropriated to promote/maintain a religion.	Regulatory fee/general tax is different.
Article 28(1)	Wholly State-funded institution: no religious instruction.	Absolute category rule.
Article 28(2)	State-administered trust/endowment requiring instruction: permitted.	Distinct exception.
Article 28(3) recognised	No compelled instruction/worship without consent.	Recognised category.
Article 28(3) aided	No compelled instruction/worship without consent.	Aided category; keep separate for four-category recall.

14. Articles 29-30 — cultural rights and minority educational autonomy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLES 29-30): Articles 29-30 protect cultural conservation, non-discriminatory admission and minority educational autonomy, but Article 29 is not minority-exclusive and Article 30 protects administration rather than maladministration.

ARTICLE 29(1)	ARTICLE 29(2)
Any section of citizens with distinct language, script or culture may conserve it. Not minority-exclusive.	No citizen denied admission to State-maintained/aided institution only on religion, race, caste, language or any of them.
ARTICLE 30	UNIT / REGULATION
Religious or linguistic minorities may establish/administer institutions of choice; State aid cannot discriminate merely for minority management.	T.M.A. Pai generally assesses minority State-wise. Standards, sanitation, teacher qualifications, fairness and excellence may be regulated; no right to maladminister.

P.A. Inamdar protects unaided professional autonomy under its framework; St Xavier's/Malankara protect management's core while permitting excellence regulation.

15. Article 32, Article 226 and the five-writ selection tree

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ARTICLE 32 / WRITS): Article 32 makes the Supreme Court a guaranteed Fundamental-Rights forum, while Article 226 is wider in subject matter and public-duty reach; the correct writ follows the defect—detention, unperformed duty, threatened excess, defective order or unlawful public office.

Defect	Writ	Target / caveat
Unlawful detention	Habeas corpus	Public or private detention; not substitute for appeal from every competent custody order.
Unperformed public duty	Mandamus	Public authority/public-duty body; not ordinarily private duty, contract, pure discretion or President/Governor constitutional capacity.
Threatened jurisdictional excess	Prohibition	Preventive; before lower court/tribunal completes the impugned act.
Defective completed order	Certiorari	Quashes jurisdictional/legal/natural-justice error in judicial, quasi-judicial or appropriate administrative action.
Unlawful public-office occupation	Quo warranto	Substantive legally created public office; relaxed standing.
Court route	32 vs 226	32 = FR and original, not exclusive; 226 = FR plus other legal rights/public duty and wider respondent reach.

16. Saving and control provisions — Articles 31A-31C and 33-35

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (SAVING / CONTROL PROVISIONS): Articles 31A-31C, 33-35 create defined constitutional controls rather than rights-free zones: their field, purpose and legislative competence remain text-bound and subject to basic-structure review where applicable.

Provision	Protection / power	Boundary
31A	Specified estate/property reform categories saved from specified 14/19 attack.	Not every property law.
31B / Ninth Schedule	Listed laws protected notwithstanding FR inconsistency.	Post-24 Apr 1973 insertions face I.R. Coelho basic-structure review.
31C	Original protection survives for genuine 39(b)/(c) laws against 14/19.	Property Owners: private resources contextual; not every asset and not every DPSP.
33	Parliament may restrict/abrogate rights of armed, public-order, intelligence and connected telecom personnel for discipline.	Parliament, not State legislature; purpose-bound.
34	Parliamentary indemnity/validation connected with martial law.	Martial law undefined and distinct from National Emergency.
35	Parliament exclusive over specified Part III matters and punishments.	Competence provision, not general immunity.

17. Emergency distinction and the non-derogable core

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (EMERGENCY): Article 358 automatically displaces Article 19 constraints only during war or external-aggression Emergency within its conditions, whereas Article 359 requires a Presidential order suspending court enforcement of specified rights and can never include Articles 20 or 21.

Point	Article 358	Article 359
Trigger	National Emergency based on war or external aggression.	Any valid National Emergency plus Presidential order.
Rights	Article 19.	Specified Part III rights except Articles 20 and 21.
Operation	Automatic within post-44th text and Emergency-related recital conditions.	Order-based; rights named, duration/area stated.
Effect	Article 19 constraint displaced; inconsistent law later ceases prospectively after Emergency, past acts preserved.	Right to move court/enforcement and pending proceedings suspended; right not textually deleted.
Core trap	Does not operate for armed-rebellion-only Emergency.	Cannot include Articles 20/21; not permanent extinction.

18. Current-law dashboard — official positions bounded to 21 August 2026

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Anchor	Controlling position	Bounded search result
Electoral Bonds · 15 Feb 2024	Political-funding information under 19(1)(a); secrecy architecture invalid; unlimited corporate-funding change manifestly arbitrary.	No later official altering merits decision located.
Davinder Singh · 1 Aug 2024	Evidence-based SC sub-classification permitted; Article 341 list unchanged; no mandatory national sub-quota.	No later official altering decision located.
Property Owners · 5 Nov 2024	Original 31C survives for 39(b)/(c); private resources require contextual inquiry.	No later official altering decision located.
DPDP · 13 Nov 2025	G.S.R. 843(E)/846(E) final Act/Rules notifications with staged commencement.	Only first tranche operative by 21 Aug 2026.
BNS/BNSS	Operative 1 Jul 2024; BNS 152 different from old 124A; BNSS arrest safeguards current.	Section 152 vires notice 28 Aug 2025; no final merits disposition located.

19. Verified PYQ routes and high-risk close-option traps

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21 ROUTED PYQS	KEY STATUS
Mains: 2019 secularism; 2021 equality India/USA; 2022 movement/residence; 2023 living Article 21 + gender justice; 2024 privacy/DNA. Prelims: 13 inferred 2018-23 + official-keyed 2024 + provisional 2026.	Never call inferred/provisional answers official. 2024 Q76 is official local key D. 2026 Q54 is provisional key D and expressly non-official.
TRAP CLUSTER I	TRAP CLUSTER II
Citizen/person; State/private; untouchability/begar; internal/foreign travel; tax/fee; propagation/conversion; procedure/due process; three months/two months.	358/359; 300A status; awards/titles; Ninth Schedule review; 31C scope; internet medium/right; Section 152 lineage; Article 12/226.

Original practice retained: 40 core MCQs + 8 remedials with strict A-B-C-D rotation; 9 solved Mains models (3 each at 10/15/20 marks).

20. Answer spines — convert exact doctrine into marks

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Marks	Answer spine	Evidence load
10	Direct thesis -> exact Article/text -> 2-3 dimensions -> one limit -> graded verdict.	2-3 precise Articles/cases.
15	Thesis -> text -> doctrinal evolution/comparison -> current application -> counterpoint -> verdict.	4-6 named authorities.
20	Architecture -> multiple rights/mechanisms -> institutional/implementation critique -> current law -> reform/verdict.	5-8 named authorities.
Universal evidence chain	Claim -> named evidence/example -> what it proves -> limitation/qualification.	Evidence must perform analysis, not decorate.
Current-law sentence	State decision/date/holding -> say whether later altering official decision was located -> avoid pending-case speculation.	Primary official source first.

Best conclusion: defend constitutional liberty without pretending that textually authorised, proportionate and reviewable limits disappear.